12.1.2 Types of Seams

There are different types of seams. The most common five types of seams are

- Plain seam
- Run and fell seam
- French seam
- Mantua maker seam
- Piped seam

12.1.2.1 Plain Seam

Plain seam is the most important and simple seam that can be used for all type of dresses. Plain seams are easy to stitch. The main advantage of this seam is it requires very little time to sew, pliable and inconspicuous. This seam can be used to stitch all types of fabric expect very light, transparent fabric or fabrics which tend to ravel off. This seam is commonly used on armholes, side seams of blouses, frocks and skirts (Figure 12.1)

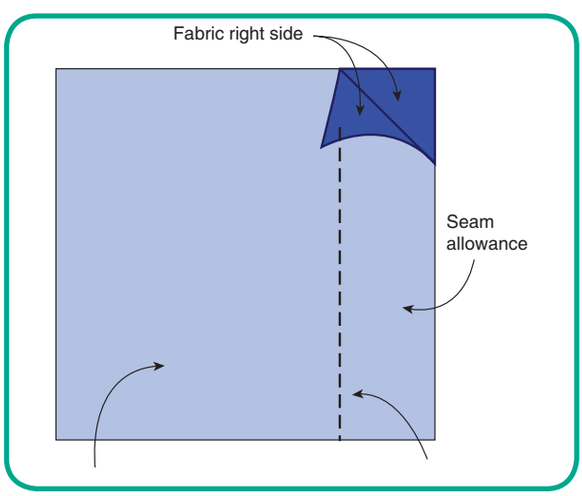


Figure 12.1 Plain Seam

Method of Sewing Plain Seam

- Take the two pieces of fabric which has to be joined together and place them facing right sides
- Check if the cut lines match
- Pin along the seam lines
- Tack along the seam line, remove pins
- Hand stitch or machine on the seam line
- Remove tacking, press open

12.1.2.2 Run and Fell Seam

Run and fell seam is commonly known as flat felt seam. As the name indicates it is very flat. It can be stitched using hand stitches or machine. The main advantage of this seam is its strength and durability. The disadvantage is time consuming and not suitable for curved edges and bulky fabrics. This seam is common on children's dresses, sports garments and shirts (Figure 12.2).

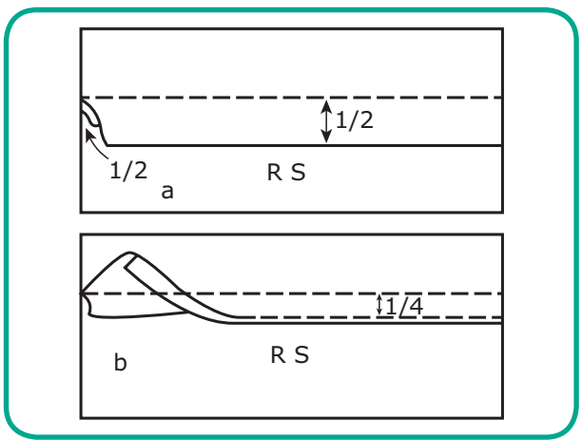


Figure 12. 2 Run and Fell Seam

Method of Sewing Run and Fell Seam

- Place the two pieces to be sewed together facing right sides
- Check if the cut lines match
- Pin along the seam line and machine
- Press both seam allowances to one side
- Trim the under seam allowance by 0.25 cm.
- Turn the upper seam allowance to make a smooth fold over the other

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